

July 26, 2026

Hiring Team — PGIM Technology

PGIM / Prudential Financial

Newark, NJ

Re: Director, Program Management — AI, PGIM Technology (Hybrid, Newark)

Dear Hiring Team,

I am applying for the Director, Program Management — AI role. Two things make me an unusual fit: I have run **50+ stakeholder regulatory programs** under hard statutory deadlines in financial services, and I **build AI systems myself** rather than only governing them. AI program leadership in an asset manager needs both, and candidates rarely bring the pair.

Program leadership at the scale PGIM operates. At JPMorgan Chase I led the firm's Resolution & Recovery Planning program, coordinating **50+ stakeholders** across Legal, Treasury, and Operations to deliver regulator-ready submissions to the Federal Reserve and FDIC. That is the shape of an enterprise AI program: many owners who do not report to you, a deadline that does not move, and an outcome that has to be defensible line by line. I also delivered the technology — automated reconciliation dashboards that cut manual review time ~40%.

AI, built and governed. At Citi I authored the AI governance framework for the internal governance team against **NIST AI RMF and SR 11-7** — model inventory, risk tiering, explainability, human-in-the-loop control design — and I shipped the tooling: a prompt-engineered **RAG document assistant** that cut review cycle time ~35%, taken from requirements through delivery and adoption. For a regulated asset manager, an AI program that cannot answer a model-risk question is a program that stalls at the first review. I have built both sides.

The adoption problem, studied properly. My doctoral work at FIU centres on bias in professional judgment: I completed an IRB-approved empirical study in July 2026, and my dissertation in development extends it to automation bias — when professionals stop exercising judgment because a tool sounded confident. Most AI programs fail not on model quality but on how people use the output. I bring a researcher's framing to the change-management half of the job, which is usually the half that decides whether the program delivers value.

Why PGIM specifically. I live in Newark. This is a firm I can commit to for the long term in the city I have built my life in, and PGIM's scale means AI programs here have real consequence for real portfolios rather than being pilots that never ship. My twenty years in banking risk — Citi, JPMorgan Chase, and the OCC as a bank examiner — mean I already speak the regulatory language PGIM's AI initiatives have to satisfy.

I would welcome the conversation.

Sincerely,

Yasir A. Malik

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